DAILY EDITORIAL SUMMARY

23rd April 2026

Topics to be covered:

- ✓ **India's Post-LWE Future, From Red Sun to New Dawn**
- ✓ **On India–South Korea Ties**

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Topics

India's Post-LWE Future, From Red Sun to New Dawn

GSIII: Linkages Between Development and Spread of Extremism

Context:

Left Wing Extremism (LWE) once posed a serious internal security threat, marked by violence, weak governance, and tribal alienation. With its decline and the 2026 declaration, India now shifts from **security-led stabilisation** to **governance-driven, inclusive transformation.**

Left Wing Extremism (LWE)

- **Origin:** Originating from **Naxalbari** and inspired by Maoist ideology, it spread across resource-rich tribal regions.

Current Status and Success Factors

- Success is driven by **cooperative federalism**, long-term planning, and coordination between **Central forces (CRPF)** and State police.
- Strong **political commitment, institutional focus, and joint strategies** ensured decline in violence.
- Shift from ideological insurgency to **ground-level confidence building and governance outreach**.

Challenges: The "Adivasi Paradox" and Resource Conflict

- Persistence of the **resource curse**: extraction of minerals with **limited local benefits**.
- Tribal communities caught between **Maoist coercion and state operations**, leading to **fear and trauma**.
- Issues of **displacement, weak service delivery, and delayed forest rights recognition**.
- Risk of **policy attention declining** as violence recedes.

Strategic Shift: From Area Domination to Governance Legitimacy

- The core challenge now is **building trust and legitimacy of the state**.
- Need for **permanent institutional presence** in **education, healthcare, and employment**.
- Adoption of **AIEEEE Framework**:
  - **Accountability, Innovation, Evidence, Equity, Empathy, Efficiency**
- Emphasis on **continuous engagement**, not episodic interventions.

Developmental and Social Solutions

(a) Economic Transformation

- Promote **local value economies** through:
  - ✓ **Forest produce processing and fair procurement**
  - ✓ **Agroforestry and allied livelihoods**
  - ✓ **MSMEs and eco-tourism**
- Ensure **community ownership, benefit-sharing, and dignified livelihoods**.

(b) Governance and Institutional Strengthening

- Focus on **last-mile delivery**:
  - ✓ Roads, schools, healthcare, banking, nutrition
  - ✓ Women's collectivisation and frontline accountability
- **Convergence via schemes:**
  - ✓ Aspirational Districts Programme
  - ✓ PM-JANMAN, DAJUGA
  - ✓ Adi Karmayogi Abhiyan
  - ✓ Article 275(1) & Tribal Sub Plan grants

(c) Justice and Rights-Based Approach

- Ensure **humane policing, legal aid, and faster justice delivery**.
- Review **undertrial cases and minor offences** affecting SC/ST communities.
- Build **trust through fairness**, as emphasised in **conflict transformation theory**.

(d) Human Capital and Youth Aspirations

- Expand opportunities via:
  - ✓ **Education, scholarships, and skill development**
  - ✓ **Women-led enterprises**
- Role of sports in inclusion, as seen in **Salima Tete** and **Mamta Hansda**.
- Initiatives like **Prime Minister Rural Development Fellowship** in nurturing talent.

Way Forward: Sustaining the Peace Dividend

- Move from **security gains to governance credibility**.
- Ensure **empathetic leadership and community participation**.
- Build **stable local economies and institutional trust**.
- Maintain **consistent state presence and accountability mechanisms**.

Conclusion

The post-LWE phase is a **moral and governance threshold**, not just a security achievement. The real test lies in converting **peace into prosperity, trust, and dignity** through **inclusive and sustained governance**. These regions are integral to India's core, and their transformation will define the success of **cooperative federalism and democratic justice**.

Mains Practice

Q. With the eradication of Left Wing Extremism (LWE), the primary challenge shifts from area domination to building governance legitimacy. Discuss the socio-economic and administrative frameworks required to ensure an inclusion-led post-conflict transformation in the erstwhile 'Red Corridor'.

(250 Words, 15 Marks) (Sumit Sir)

On India–South Korea Ties

GS: II: Bilateral, Regional and Global Groupings and Agreements involving India and/or affecting India's interests.

Context:

India and the **Republic of Korea (South Korea)** have reinvigorated ties with the **2026 visit of President Lee Jae Myung**, the first in eight years.

Focus of Visit:

- The engagement focused on strengthening **trade, technology, and strategic cooperation**, marking a shift toward a **future-oriented Special Strategic Partnership** amid global uncertainties.

Key Outcomes and Economic Framework

- Signing of **15 Memorandums of Understanding (MOUs)** across economic sectors.
- Commitment to raise **bilateral trade from $27 billion to $50 billion by 2030**.
- Upgradation of the **Comprehensive Economic Partnership Agreement (CEPA)** to reduce tariffs and liberalise services.
- Collaboration leveraging **Korean technology** and **India's scale**, especially in manufacturing and innovation.

Pillars of Strategic Cooperation

(a) Core Values

- Shared commitment to **Democracy, Market Economy, and Rule of Law**.

(b) Emerging Strategic Sectors

- Cooperation in **shipbuilding, maritime logistics, energy security, and sustainability**.
- Focus on **critical minerals** (lithium, cobalt, nickel) and **quantum computing**.
- Successful defence collaboration example: **K9 Vajra Howitzer**.

Strategic and Geopolitical Convergence

- Alignment between India's **Act East Policy** and Korea's **Indo-Pacific Strategy**.
- Shared concerns over:
  - **Supply chain disruptions** in West Asia and the Red Sea
  - **Energy security challenges**
  - Impact of **global conflicts** on trade and stability
- Need to build a **resilient, long-term partnership** beyond transactional engagement.

Cultural and Historical Linkages

- Ancient ties through **Princess Suriratna (Heo Hwang-ok)** linked to **Ayodhya**.
- Growing **soft power exchanges**: popularity of **K-pop and K-dramas** in India.
- Despite this, **tourism and people-to-people exchanges remain limited**.

Challenges and Untapped Potential

- **Low bilateral trade** relative to economic size.
- Significant gap in **human mobility and expatriate presence**.
- Pending issues in **investment protection and service sector access**.
- **Delayed finalisation of CEPA upgrades**.
- Need for stronger **political and strategic engagement mechanisms**.

Way Forward: Towards a Transformational Partnership

- **Fast-track CEPA negotiations** to unlock trade potential.
- Enhance **people-to-people exchanges and tourism flows**.
- Strengthen cooperation in **critical technologies and supply chains**.
- Deepen **Indo-Pacific coordination** for shared security and economic interests.
- Build **resilient frameworks** to manage global shocks and disruptions.

Conclusion

India–South Korea relations stand at a crucial juncture, with strong foundations in **shared values, economic complementarities, and strategic convergence**. Converting this into a **transformational partnership** requires addressing existing gaps and sustaining momentum.

A deeper, resilient engagement will enable both nations to **weather geopolitical uncertainties and shape a stable Indo-Pacific order**.

Mains Practice

Q. Despite having shared democratic values and deep historical linkages, the true economic and strategic potential between India and South Korea remains unrealized. Critically analyze the challenges hindering this bilateral relationship and suggest measures to overcome them in the light of recent geopolitical turmoils.

(250 Words, 15 Marks) (Sumit Sir)

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